

2099 Benefits Guide

Northwind Labs · People Operations · Plan year 2099

This guide explains the benefits available to full-time employees: health insurance, retirement, paid leave programs, and learning and wellness support. It complements the Paid Time Off Policy · that policy governs your day-to-day PTO accrual and rollover, while this guide covers the longer, program-based forms of leave.

Health and Insurance

Northwind offers medical, dental, and vision plans. The company pays the majority of the premium; your share depends on the tier you select and whether you cover dependents. Coverage begins on the first of the month after your start date.

Plan	Employee monthly	Family monthly	Deductible
Core PPO	\$48	\$190	\$1,500
Plus PPO	\$92	\$310	\$750
High-deductible + HSA	\$0	\$120	\$3,000

Retirement

Employees may contribute to the 401(k) plan from their first paycheck. Northwind matches 100% of the first 4% of eligible pay you contribute; the match vests immediately. You can change your contribution rate at any time through the benefits portal.

Paid Leave Programs

Beyond standard paid time off, Northwind provides several dedicated leave programs. These are separate from your PTO balance and do not draw it down.

- Parental leave: 16 weeks of fully paid leave for the birth or adoption of a child, available to all new parents within the first year.
- Bereavement leave: up to 5 paid days for the loss of an immediate family member.
- Jury duty: paid in full for the duration of service.
- Sabbatical: after five continuous years, a four-week paid sabbatical, scheduled with manager approval so the team has coverage.

Learning and Wellness

Every employee receives an annual learning budget of \$1,500 for courses, books, conferences, and certifications relevant to their role. Unused learning budget does not carry into the next year. A separate wellness stipend of \$50 per month may be used for fitness, mental-health apps, or ergonomic accessories.

Using the learning budget

Purchases under \$200 need no pre-approval; above that, get your manager's approval first. Submit

the receipt through the same expense workflow used for business expenses, tagged as Learning, and you will be reimbursed on the next cycle.

Reimbursements and Commuter Benefits

Tuition reimbursement of up to \$5,000 per year is available for approved degree programs with a passing grade. Commuter benefits let you set aside pre-tax dollars for transit and parking. Both are requested through the benefits portal; reimbursement timelines match the standard expense policy.

Time Off and Holidays

This guide does not set your day-to-day paid-time-off accrual or its rollover cap · those belong to the Paid Time Off Policy · but it is worth knowing how the pieces fit together. PTO covers vacation and personal days and accrues across the year. Sick leave is tracked separately and is not capped the way PTO rollover is. Company holidays are in addition to PTO, and the leave programs above sit on top of all of it.

Program	Length	Pay	Approval
Parental leave	16 weeks	100% paid	People Ops
Bereavement	Up to 5 days	100% paid	Manager
Sabbatical	4 weeks / 5 yrs	100% paid	Manager
Jury duty	As required	100% paid	Notify manager

Wellness and Support

Beyond the monthly wellness stipend, Northwind provides a confidential employee assistance program offering counseling and financial and legal guidance at no cost, and a subsidized membership to a telehealth provider. These services are independent of your medical plan and do not affect your deductible.

Enrollment and Contacts

New hires enroll within 30 days of their start date. Outside of that window, changes require a qualifying life event such as marriage, a new dependent, or a change in a spouse's coverage. Open enrollment for the following plan year runs each November. Questions about any benefit go to People Operations through the benefits portal or the #benefits channel; for a claim dispute, contact the carrier directly using the number on your insurance card and copy People Operations so we can help escalate.